BREAKOUT SESSIONS

SUNDAY, NOVEMBER 15, 2026 · BOSTON, MA

SESSION 01

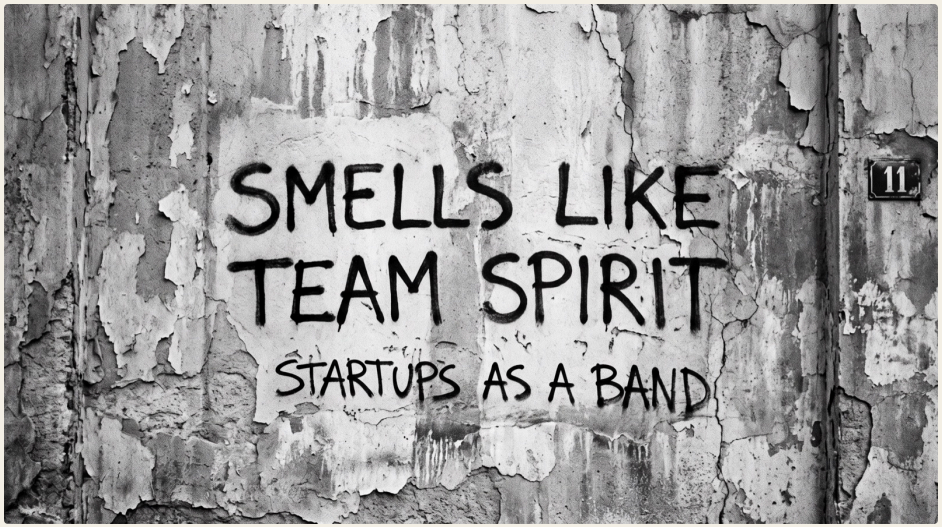


PMF Is Gonna Rock Ya!

Why Good Products Stall, Unexpected Ideas Succeed, and Timing Is Everything

How did Cursor spend years searching for the right product before becoming an AI coding sensation? How did fal turn a Python data science tool into a generative AI powerhouse? Through real stories from the PWV (Preston-Werner Ventures) portfolio, we'll explore product-market fit: how startups discover what customers actually want, why timing and finding the right buyer matter, and why even brilliant technology can struggle to find a market.

SESSION 02



Smells Like Team Spirit: Startups as a Band

Teen Spirit was a deodorant-scented slogan that became a revolutionary anthem for Gen X. Team Spirit is the strategy for a next-generation startup.

Every startup is a band. We'll look at what solo founders, duos, trios, and quartets each get right and wrong, why the person you pick for the launch may not be the person you want in the van for ten years, and why success doesn't end the pressure — after the raise, after PMF, it changes shape, and handling it is what keeps the band from breaking up. Expect practical questions, real stories, and a little chaos.



David Thyresson (DT)

COFOUNDER & GENERAL PARTNER, PWV (PRESTON-WERNER VENTURES)

DT is a technical founder turned investor with a track record of building and exiting startups. At PWV (Preston-Werner Ventures), he works hands-on with founders to turn complex ideas into products that scale. He also writes about how technology, culture, and creativity shape and challenge each other. When not investing in companies, he invests in vintage synths and drum machines.

REGISTER

LUMA.COM/AU81VQZ3